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Level of The Week: Megalith2

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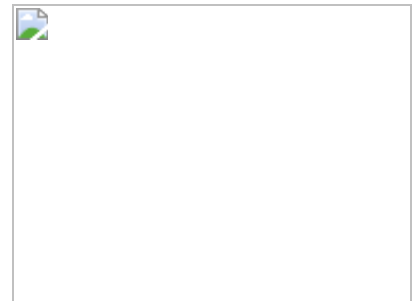
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Nice face textures that light up when the stone button is pushed.



Interesting architecture on several levels.



Beautiful colors.

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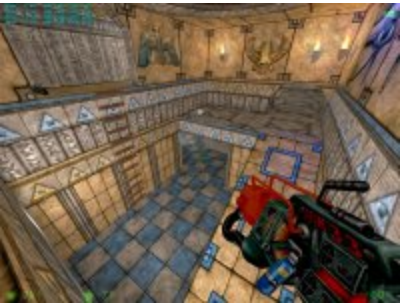
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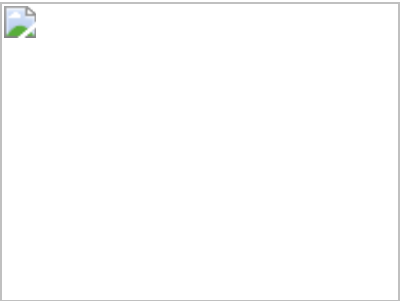
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Beautiful artwork throughout!



This teleporter and the tunnel you transport through kicks ass. One of the best ever seen.



Georgous lava bath when red button above is activated.



Here is the fountain of life.

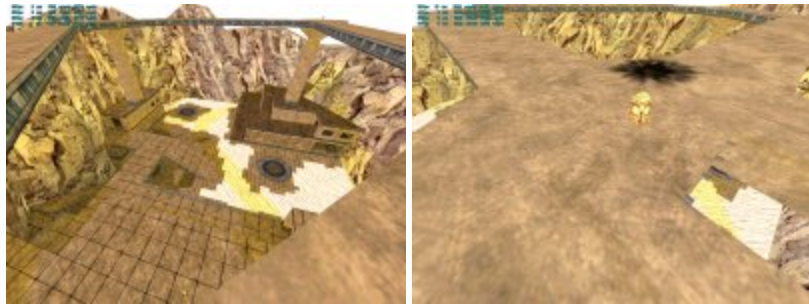
Level Type:	Half-Life DM Level
Map Author:	Mazemaster
Author's Website:	None
Map Download:	Megalith2 Zip (6.4 MB)
Readme File:	Megalith Readme
Recommended Players:	8-20
Review Date:	January 30 th, 2002
Reviewer:	Mikee

Megalith2 is one of those maps with a checkered past. I originally saw the first version of it, called **Megalith**, at [Juim's Hot Death Diner](#). I was immediately impressed with what a wonderful job **Mazemaster** did on most of this map. As I wandered around, I knew I was looking at one of those rare, high quality maps that makes you say "WOW" a lot.

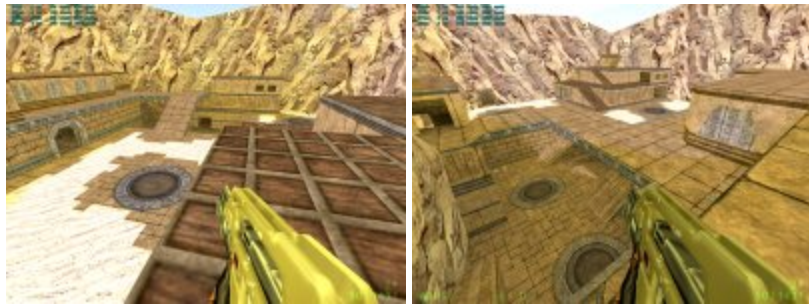
However, when I began to look at **Megalith** more closely, I found 4-5 protruding brush errors, jump pads that didn't work and an obvious untextured open hole above an outside door. Most noteworthy of all was the out-of-place, bizarre-looking and unrealistic raised stone ring that clashed with the elegant artwork and architecture.

As I expected, the r_speed wpolys on top of this ring platform were consistently in the 1,100 to 1,350 range (see below). I contacted **Mazemaster** to let him know what I found, and to his credit he fixed these obvious errors, as well as removing the top ring, which he had added at the last minute. In my opinion, this **Megalith2** version is far superior to the first map, and I highly recommend getting it.

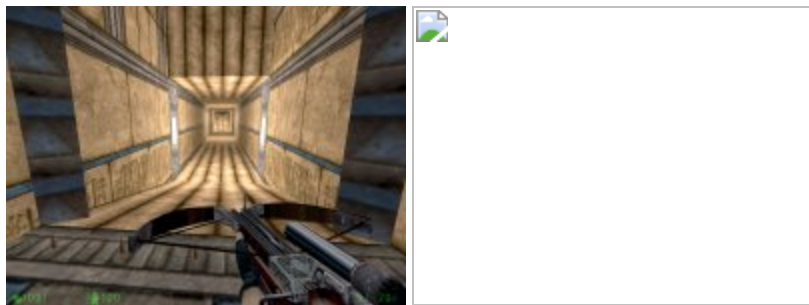
For what it's worth, here are some screenshots of both maps that I took using Open GL video mode, normal FOV of 90, and resolution of 1024x768.



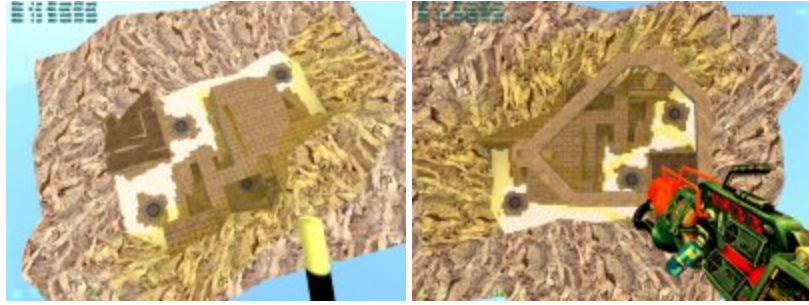
Without the ring structure, the outside upper area in **Megalith2** is now much cleaner-looking and artistically consistent with the theme of the map, and devoid of R_Speed problems.



These next two views show the wonderful switch-activated tunnel with the RPG at the far end. The button shown will drop a perfectly round large boulder (like from the Indiana Jones movie) and kill anyone in here. The two blue stone buttons (pressed in any order) open this gate, and are on a pretty long timer. I'm trying to put Dino back in his cage, but he said something about biting my butt if I try... Damn kids!



These two sky views show the much improved and cleaner Megalith2 version, and what I am calling the "Rings of Hell" from the first Megalith on the right.



Overall, the outside area plays very well, with plenty of buildings and windows to hide behind for sniping wars. The most spectacular part of **Megalith2** is the inside underground complex. **Mazemaster** should change his name to "Amaze-Master" because I was truly amazed at the beautiful texturing, excellent architectural design, cool lighting, and unusual special effects.

You can see from all the pictures that I had a hard time figuring out which ones to eliminate, because there are so many well done areas in **Megalith2**. There is a cool tunnel containing the RPG that will open when you push both blue stones. The spiked gate is on a pretty good timer, so you will have plenty of time to get the RPG. That is unless some jerk doesn't come by and push the button which releases a perfectly round (not an easy thing to do in HL), Indiana Jones crushing boulder.

The sounds are also better in this version. You will find plenty of weapons, ammo and items, including two long jumps. Now the r_speed wpolys throughout the map never go above 800, which is fabulous in a map this big. It is rare to find a large map that is well made, and many large servers will enjoy running **Megalith2**.

FINAL WORD:

Megalith2 is a very well made, fast-moving and fun Egyptian-theme map. **Mazemaster** should be very proud of the obvious work he put into this map. It is a lot of fun to explore, including the water to lava fountain, and the RPG trap. This has to rank up there as one of the nicest large maps that I can think of. Make sure you add this one to your collection.

[This is an excellent large map with an Egyptian theme. Nice Job!](#)

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If you have any questions or comments about this Level of the Week, contact [Mikee](#)... He Likes it!!



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